MODULE 37 · EXAM STRATEGY - ALL SECTIONS

How Databricks writes these questions

Reading the question as instructions, handling NOT and choose-two items, recognising distractor families, and pacing the exam.

SECTION All sections EXAM WEIGHT - MODULE 37 of 40

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Read the question as a set of instructions. **Every constraint in it is there to rule an option out.**

What you are working with

	DETAIL
Questions	45 scored, plus possible unscored ones you cannot identify
Formats	Multiple choice, and multiple selection such as choose two
Time	90 minutes: about two minutes per question
Delivery	Proctored, online or at a test centre, with no aids

ON THE EXAM

Treat every question as scored. Two minutes each is generous if you read carefully the first time.

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Five steps for every question

01

Read the ask

The last line first: what is being asked?

02

Collect constraints

Scale, latency, cost, must, never, least.

03

Name the concept

Which stage, and which tiebreaker?

04

Eliminate

Strike options that break a constraint.

05

Choose

The one that meets every constraint.

ON THE EXAM

Reading the ask first tells you which details matter, so the scenario reads faster and with purpose.

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Qualifiers and what they point to

THE QUESTION SAYS	IT USUALLY POINTS TO
Least effort, least code, fewest steps	A builder, an all-rounder, or a managed feature
Most reliable, guaranteed, must never	An enforced control, not a prompt
Lowest cost, most efficient	The smallest option that still passes
First, before anything else	Diagnose or prepare before fixing
Best	The option meeting every stated constraint
NOT, EXCEPT, least likely	Three good practices and one odd one out

ON THE EXAM

Circle the qualifier mentally before reading the options. It is usually the deciding constraint.

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Handling a question that asks for the wrong one

- Restate it positively: which three of these **are** good practice?
- Tick each good practice. The one left unticked is the answer.
- The odd one out is often **more, bigger, or from the wrong layer**.
- The classic slip: choosing a correct practice because you forgot the NOT.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> Say the word NOT to yourself when you read it, and again before you click.

Handling multiple selection

- Judge **each option on its own**: true for this scenario, or not?
- The two answers are often **complementary**, such as bigger chunks and less overlap.
- Two options that say the same thing in different words are rarely both right.
- If one answer is certain, test the others against it.
- Choose exactly the number asked for.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> A choose-two question is two true-or-false questions in one. Both must be right to score.

Wrong answers you will keep meeting

FAMILY	EXAMPLE FROM THE COURSE
True, but the wrong question	A reranker for a recall failure
Right tool, wrong side or phase	Output redaction when data must never leave
A prompt instead of a control	Tell the model not to reveal data
The bigger-model reflex	A frontier model for simple labelling
The fine-tuning reflex	Fine-tune to add fresh facts
Newest is best	Rejecting a supported path as legacy
Over-engineering	A multi-agent system for a fixed flow

ON THE EXAM

Name the family when you strike an option. It makes elimination faster and more confident.

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When the question asks for a sequence

- Put the **irreversible** step last, and checks before it.
- Put **dependencies** first: you need the order before its refund status.
- Data: parse, then chunk, then **flatten**, then write, then index.
- Release: log, register, evaluate, then move the alias.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> Most sequence questions have one step that must come last and one that must come first. Anchor those, then fill in.

A plan for ninety minutes

01

Pass one

About 60 minutes. Answer everything, flag doubts.

02

Pass two

About 20 minutes on flagged questions only.

03

Final check

About 10 minutes: NOT and choose-two items.

ON THE EXAM

Never leave a question blank. An unanswered question cannot score, and a reasoned guess often can.

Habits that protect marks

- Read every option before choosing, even when the first looks right.
- Change an answer only for a **specific reason**, not a feeling.
- Map unfamiliar names to concepts, as module 35 showed.
- If two options both seem right, reread the constraints: one will break.
- Trust the tiebreakers. They were built from what the exam tests.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> Most lost marks come from reading, not knowledge. Slow down on the question, not on the options.

> An AI Search index holds 30 million chunk records. The team must roughly halve the record count without removing any source content.
>
> Choose TWO.

Which two changes achieve this?

A Increase the chunk size

B Increase the chunk overlap

C Add more metadata columns

D Reduce the chunk overlap

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which two changes achieve this?

A Increase the chunk size

A longer stride means fewer chunks.

B Increase the overlap

A shorter stride means more chunks.

C More metadata columns

Wider rows. The count is unchanged.

D Reduce the overlap

A longer stride means fewer chunks.

THE SIGNAL

Two complementary levers on the same quantity: stride. Judge each option on its own, then check the pair makes sense.

> A team is reviewing ways to control the cost of its generative AI applications.
>
> Several proposals are on the table.

Which proposal would NOT reduce cost?

A. Use the smallest model that passes the evaluation

B. Raise max_tokens so answers are never cut short

C. Batch table jobs through a single ai_query call

D. Switch nightly-updated indexes to triggered sync

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which proposal would NOT reduce cost?

A Smallest passing model

Reduces cost. Modules 11 and 33.

B Raise max_tokens

Allows longer outputs: cost goes up, not down.

C One ai_query batch

Reduces cost. Module 24.

D Triggered sync

Reduces cost. Module 21.

THE SIGNAL

Restate positively: which three reduce cost? Tick A, C and D. The one left is the answer.

> An HR team wants staff to get cited answers from 2,000 policy PDFs stored in a Unity Catalog volume.
>
> It must be delivered with the LEAST development effort.

Which approach fits?

A. A LangGraph agent with custom chunking logic

B. A model fine-tuned on all of the policy PDFs

C. A Knowledge Assistant over the PDF volume

D. A custom pyfunc rag chain on Model Serving

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which approach fits?

A LangGraph agent
Works, with far more effort.

B Fine-tuned model
No citations, and much more effort.

C Knowledge Assistant
Cited answers from a volume, configured not coded.

D Custom pyfunc chain
Works, with far more effort.

THE SIGNAL

LEAST development effort, cited answers, a volume of PDFs. The qualifier points to a builder, and the task names which one.

What to carry forward

- Read the ask first, collect constraints, name the concept, eliminate, choose.
- Qualifiers decide: **least effort**, **most reliable**, **lowest cost**, **first**, **NOT**.
- NOT: tick the three good ones. Choose two: judge each option alone.
- Name the distractor family as you strike it.
- Pace: 60, 20, 10 minutes. Never leave a question blank.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> Next: three practice exams, timed, to put all of this together.